



Skyward bound: 19-year-old Pooja, who won Asian high-jump gold with a 1.93m leap, is ranked fifth in the Glasgow field. GETTY IMAGES

contesting for a medal, he has the chance to improve his national record further and edge closer to the 10-second barrier — something he has set as a career goal.

Also looking to improve on her national record will be 19-year-old high jumper Pooja, who won junior Asian gold with a clearance of 1.93m. While Pooja's season's best places her only fifth among competitors in Glasgow — behind Australia's Eleanor Patterson (2m) and Nicola Olyslagers (1.99m), Nigeria's Temitope Adeshina (1.97m) and Jamaica's Lamara Distin (1.96m) — the Indian is still improving and could well produce another personal best.

With age on her side, it's likely that Pooja will continue to improve in the years to come. The Commonwealth Games, if anything, will be another stepping stone in her career. For Neeraj, though, there's likely more at stake.

While he doesn't have much left to prove, there's no doubt he won't want to be simply another competitor. His performance in Doha indicated that although he's still got some way to go, he's clearly on the way back to his best. Both Neeraj and India will hope he gets there in Glasgow.



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